COT DUAL-SOURCE + COMMERCIAL/RETAIL BREAKDOWN

Data: Week Ending October 27, 2026 | Analysis: October 30, 2026

Source 1 -- Leveraged Funds: CFTC TFF's speculative cohort (hedge funds/CTAs); Disaggregated Managed Money for GOLD/SILVER/CRUDE/NATGAS. **Asset Manager:** CFTC TFF's real-money institutional cohort (pension funds, insurers, mutual funds), tracked as its own series with its own net position/COT index/bias, same treatment as Leveraged Funds -- not available for GOLD/SILVER/CRUDE/NATGAS (the Disaggregated report has no Asset Manager category). **Source 2 -- Non-Commercial:** Tradingster Legacy Non-Commercial (broader spec group = Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined). **Commercial/Retail:** CFTC Legacy report's classic 3-way split (Commercial hedgers vs. large speculators vs. small/retail traders), same underlying Tradingster data as Source 2. **Third Source:** a genuinely independent, non-CFTC check where a free one exists -- OANDA position book (forex), Crypto Fear & Greed Index (BTC), EIA weekly crude stocks (Oil), EIA weekly natural gas storage vs. 5-yr average (NatGas). No free independent source exists for indices or Gold/Silver. **COT Index:** Larry Williams percentile over full history -- Bullish >=60 | Bearish <=40 | Neutral 40-60.

Source 1 -- CFTC Leveraged Funds / Managed Money (net contracts)

SYM	09-29	10-06	10-13	10-20	10-27	COT INDEX	BIAS	LEVERAGED FUNDS SIGNAL
EUR	-39265	-44261	-68001	-68840	-71574	0	Bearish	--
GBP	4606	12432	10313	24104	17195	35	Bearish	flip-DN
JPY	-14161	-25043	-33673	-22890	-14630	73	Bullish	covering
NZD	-1066	-787	-11619	-19280	-22554	27	Bearish	--
USD	361	864	2076	3183	3158	82	Bullish	flip-DN
ES	-374007	-415909	-410518	-372869	-399879	42	Neutral	flip-DN
NQ	-24723	-19212	-11593	950	2301	86	Bullish	pressing
US30	-5386	-1894	4327	-725	2124	93	Bullish	flip-UP
BTC	-6856	-6852	-5844	-4942	-3979	100	Bullish	--
GOLD	124418	114820	111079	108685	107404	20	Bearish	covering
SILVER	7738	7608	5735	3746	2902	0	Bearish	--
CRUDE	122916	104491	102765	101906	99771	73	Bullish	--
NATGAS	-132849	-144681	-126156	-156848	-205464	0	Bearish	pressing
VIX	-7467	5494	1105	-20890	-26334	31	Bearish	--

Asset Manager -- CFTC TFF Real-Money Institutional: Pension Funds, Insurers, Mutual Funds (net contracts)

SYM	09-29	10-06	10-13	10-20	10-27	COT INDEX	BIAS	ASSET MANAGER SIGNAL
EUR	220603	189881	199918	190421	173249	0	Bearish	--
GBP	-128544	-145442	-145735	-134621	-128893	18	Bearish	--
JPY	51634	67795	65819	79103	91191	98	Bullish	--
NZD	-21228	-32534	-44139	-49313	-46841	22	Bearish	flip-UP
USD	18007	19096	18164	17020	16713	84	Bullish	--
ES	906259	909302	918097	904019	926147	39	Bearish	flip-UP
NQ	69744	73798	75323	77790	65381	36	Bearish	flip-DN
US30	14911	19595	10871	13040	12209	72	Bullish	flip-DN
BTC	3586	3532	3642	2999	2754	11	Bearish	--
VIX	-66500	-80614	-77295	-57459	-44424	69	Bullish	--

Not available for GOLD/SILVER/CRUDE/NATGAS -- the Disaggregated report has no Asset Manager category (its cohorts are Producer/Merchant, Swap Dealer, and Managed Money instead).

Source 2 -- Tradingster Non-Commercial (Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager Combined)

SYM	09-29	10-06	10-13	10-20	10-27	COT INDEX	BIAS	ALIGNMENT
EUR	-63256	-99332	-137573	-134524	-143894	0	Bearish	CONFIRMED
GBP	-91075	-97611	-106964	-80420	-79414	11	Bearish	CONFIRMED
JPY	55440	62325	50207	69878	101591	79	Bullish	CONFIRMED
NZD	-17315	-29346	-47001	-58149	-57690	7	Bearish	CONFIRMED
USD	11881	12011	12919	15044	14121	42	Neutral	DIVERGE
ES	-144956	-155651	-142709	-143277	-132661	53	Neutral	NEUTRAL
NQ	51247	58123	48523	50726	48839	69	Bullish	CONFIRMED
US30	10026	11803	9721	7856	9599	55	Neutral	DIVERGE
BTC	2465	2540	2534	2418	2720	86	Bullish	CONFIRMED
GOLD	218632	210335	207879	199865	186451	57	Neutral	DIVERGE
SILVER	22083	23153	22631	19795	19703	36	Bearish	CONFIRMED
CRUDE	109463	99060	100343	89325	74343	5	Bearish	DIVERGE
NATGAS	-231020	-236439	-233578	-241272	-255164	2	Bearish	CONFIRMED
VIX	-79610	-91294	-96455	-96509	-77466	55	Neutral	DIVERGE

Smart Money Score -- Commercial / Asset Manager / Leveraged Funds vs. Retail

Weights: Commercial 50% (most reliable smart money vs. Retail), Asset Manager 30%, Leveraged Funds 20% (trend-following, weakest for a contrarian read) -- renormalized to Commercial ~71%/Leveraged Funds ~29% for GOLD/SILVER/CRUDE/NATGAS (no Asset Manager data). Score = weighted cohort index minus Retail's own index; positive fades Retail short, negative fades Retail long. Prior-week score shown for short-term direction (building/fading/flipping), not just current level.

SYM	COMMERCIAL	ASSET MANAGER	LEVERAGED FUNDS	RETAIL	SCORE	PRIOR WK	SIGNAL
EUR	Bullish (90)	Bearish (0)	Bearish (0)	Neutral (51)	-6	-4	Neutral / No Edge
GBP	Bullish (88)	Bearish (18)	Bearish (35)	Bearish (37)	+19	+31	Neutral / No Edge
JPY	Bearish (24)	Bullish (98)	Bullish (73)	Bullish (62)	-6	+0	Neutral / No Edge
NZD	Bullish (91)	Bearish (22)	Bearish (27)	Bearish (33)	+24	+30	Bullish (Fade Retail)
USD	Bullish (60)	Bullish (84)	Bullish (82)	Bearish (38)	+34	+33	Bullish (Fade Retail)
ES	Bearish (37)	Bearish (39)	Neutral (42)	Bullish (85)	-46	-41	Bearish (Fade Retail)
NQ	Bearish (28)	Bearish (36)	Bullish (86)	Bullish (75)	-33	-24	Bearish (Fade Retail)
US30	Bearish (38)	Bullish (72)	Bullish (93)	Bullish (68)	-9	+0	Neutral / No Edge
BTC	Bearish (12)	Bearish (11)	Bullish (100)	Bearish (19)	+10	+8	Neutral / No Edge
GOLD	Neutral (41)	N/A	Bearish (20)	Neutral (54)	-19	-38	Neutral / No Edge
SILVER	Bullish (62)	N/A	Bearish (0)	Neutral (48)	-4	-11	Neutral / No Edge
CRUDE	Bullish (93)	N/A	Bullish (73)	Neutral (55)	+32	+33	Bullish (Fade Retail)
NATGAS	Bullish (100)	N/A	Bearish (0)	Bearish (38)	+33	+37	Bullish (Fade Retail)
VIX	Neutral (47)	Bullish (69)	Bearish (31)	Bearish (28)	+22	+20	Bullish (Fade Retail)

Third-Source Independent Check (non-CFTC -- forex/BTC/Oil/NatGas only, see note above)

SYM	SOURCE	READING	BIAS
EUR	OANDA Position Book	62.4% Long / 37.6% Short	Bullish
GBP	OANDA Position Book	59.3% Long / 40.7% Short	Neutral
JPY	OANDA Position Book	35.3% Long / 64.6% Short	Bearish
NZD	OANDA Position Book	57.0% Long / 43.0% Short	Neutral
USD	OANDA Position Book	39.2% Long / 60.8% Short	Bearish
BTC	Crypto Fear & Greed	30/100 (Fear)	Neutral
CRUDE	EIA Weekly Crude Stocks	-1,892 thousand bbl	Neutral

SYM	SOURCE	READING	BIAS
NATGAS	EIA Nat Gas Storage	+80 Bcf vs 5-yr avg +80 Bcf	Neutral

Instrument-by-Instrument Analysis

-- FOREX --

EUR	**Commercial: Bullish IDX 90**	**Asset Manager: Bearish IDX 0**	**Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 0**	**Retail: Neutral IDX 51**
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		**Score: -6 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: -4**	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -39,265 -> -71,574 (-32,309 over 4 wks). COT Index 0 (Bearish). Asset Manager net +220,603 -> +173,249 (-47,354 over 4 wks). COT Index 0 (Bearish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net -63,256 -> -143,894 (-80,638). COT Index 0 (Bearish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 90 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 51 (Neutral).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bearish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). CFTC IDX=0 near historical bearish extreme -- crowd very one-sided short; contrarian squeeze risk is elevated. Non-Commercial IDX=0 also at bearish extreme -- broad spec group maximally short. Commercials (Bullish) and Retail (Neutral) disagree, though not both at a clean bullish/bearish extreme -- worth noting who's on which side of this move. Third-source check (Bullish) diverges from Source 1 (Bearish) -- institutional COT positioning and the independent check disagree.

Smart Money Score: Score -6, prior week -4 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: OANDA clients: 62.4% long / 37.6% short (Bullish) -- independent broker order book, not CFTC data.

This week (Oct 30):

Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 90) vs. Hedge funds IDX 0, Non-Commercial IDX 0 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.

Next week (Nov 3):

Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

GBP	**Commercial: Bullish IDX 88**	**Asset Manager: Bearish IDX 18**	**Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 35**	**Retail: Bearish IDX 37**
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		**Score: +19 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: +31**	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net +4,606 -> +17,195 (+12,589 over 4 wks). COT Index 35 (Bearish). Leveraged Funds delta turned negative (new shorts or long liquidation). Asset Manager net -128,544 -> -128,893 (-349 over 4 wks). COT Index 18 (Bearish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net -91,075 -> -79,414 (+11,661). COT Index 11 (Bearish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 88 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 37 (Bearish).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bearish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). Leveraged Funds weekly delta crossed negative -- new shorts or long liquidation. Smart money (Commercial) is Bullish while Retail (dumb money) is Bearish -- classic contrarian accumulation signal. This directly contradicts the Bearish speculator-side read above -- weigh it before treating that as a clean signal.

Smart Money Score: Score +19, prior week +31 -- edge collapsed to neutral from a real reading last week.

Third-Source Check: OANDA clients: 59.3% long / 40.7% short (Neutral) -- independent broker order book, not CFTC data.

This week (Oct 30):

Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 88) vs. Non-Commercial IDX 11 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.

Next week (Nov 3):

Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

JPY	**Commercial: Bearish IDX 24**	**Asset Manager: Bullish IDX 98**	**Leveraged Funds: Bullish IDX 73**	**Retail: Bullish IDX 62**
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		**Score: -6 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: +0**	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -14,161 -> -14,630 (-469 over 4 wks). COT Index 73 (Bullish). Leveraged Funds covering above-average pace. Asset Manager net +51,634 -> +91,191 (+39,557 over 4 wks). COT Index 98 (Bullish). Non-Commercial

(Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +55,440 -> +101,591 (+46,151). COT Index 79 (Bullish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 24 (Bearish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 62 (Bullish).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bullish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). Smart money (Commercial) is Bearish while Retail (dumb money) is Bullish -- classic contrarian distribution warning. This directly contradicts the Bullish speculator-side read above -- weigh it before treating that as a clean signal. Third-source check (Bearish) diverges from Source 1 (Bullish) -- institutional COT positioning and the independent check disagree.

Smart Money Score: Score -6, prior week +0 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: OANDA clients: 35.3% long / 64.6% short (Bearish) -- independent broker order book, not CFTC data.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 24). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

NZD	Commercial: Bullish IDX 91	Asset Manager: Bearish IDX 22	Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 27	Retail: Bearish IDX 33
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		Score: +24 (Bullish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: +30	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -1,066 -> -22,554 (-21,488 over 4 wks). COT Index 27 (Bearish). Asset Manager net -21,228 -> -46,841 (-25,613 over 4 wks). COT Index 22 (Bearish). Asset Manager delta turned positive (short-covering or new longs). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net -17,315 -> -57,690 (-40,375). COT Index 7 (Bearish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 91 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 33 (Bearish).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bearish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). Smart money (Commercial) is Bullish while Retail (dumb money) is Bearish -- classic contrarian accumulation signal. This directly contradicts the Bearish speculator-side read above -- weigh it before treating that as a clean signal.

Smart Money Score: Score +24, prior week +30 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: OANDA clients: 57.0% long / 43.0% short (Neutral) -- independent broker order book, not CFTC data.

This week (Oct 30):

Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 91) vs. Non-Commercial IDX 7 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.

Next week (Nov 3):

Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

USD	Commercial: Bullish IDX 60	Asset Manager: Bullish IDX 84	Leveraged Funds: Bullish IDX 82	Retail: Bearish IDX 38
	Alignment: DIVERGE		Score: +34 (Bullish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: +33	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net +361 -> +3,158 (+2,797 over 4 wks). COT Index 82 (Bullish). Leveraged Funds delta turned negative (new shorts or long liquidation). Asset Manager net +18,007 -> +16,713 (-1,294 over 4 wks). COT Index 84 (Bullish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +11,881 -> +14,121 (+2,240). COT Index 42 (Neutral). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 60 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 38 (Bearish).

Analysis: Source divergence: CFTC Bullish (IDX 82) vs Tradingster Neutral (IDX 42). Hedge-fund sources disagree -- context only. Leveraged Funds weekly delta crossed negative -- new shorts or long liquidation. Smart money (Commercial) is Bullish while Retail (dumb money) is Bearish -- classic contrarian accumulation signal. Third-source check (Bearish) diverges from Source 1 (Bullish) -- institutional COT positioning and the independent check disagree.

Smart Money Score: Score +34, prior week +33 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: OANDA clients: 39.2% long / 60.8% short (Bearish) -- independent broker order book, not CFTC data.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 60). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

-- INDICES --

ES	Commercial: Bearish IDX 37	Asset Manager: Bearish IDX 39	Leveraged Funds: Neutral IDX 42	Retail: Bullish IDX 85
	Alignment: NEUTRAL		Score: -46 (Bearish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: -41	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -374,007 -> -399,879 (-25,872 over 4 wks). COT Index 42 (Neutral). Leveraged Funds delta turned negative (new shorts or long liquidation). Asset Manager net +906,259 -> +926,147 (+19,888 over 4 wks). COT Index 39 (Bearish). Asset Manager delta turned positive (short-covering or new longs). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net -144,956 -> -132,661 (+12,295). COT Index 53 (Neutral). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 37 (Bearish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 85 (Bullish).

Analysis: Both sources neutral -- no COT directional edge. Leveraged Funds weekly delta crossed negative -- new shorts or long liquidation. Smart money (Commercial) is Bearish while Retail (dumb money) is Bullish -- classic contrarian distribution warning.

Smart Money Score: Score -46, prior week -41 -- stable.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 37). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

NQ	Commercial: Bearish IDX 28	Asset Manager: Bearish IDX 36	Leveraged Funds: Bullish IDX 86	Retail: Bullish IDX 75
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		Score: -33 (Bearish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: -24	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds flipped from net short 24,723 (4 wks ago) to net long 2,301 now. COT Index 86 (Bullish). Leveraged Funds pressing at above-average pace. Asset Manager net +69,744 -> +65,381 (-4,363 over 4 wks). COT Index 36 (Bearish). Asset Manager delta turned negative (new shorts or long liquidation). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +51,247 -> +48,839 (-2,408). COT Index 69 (Bullish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 28 (Bearish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 75 (Bullish).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bullish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). Smart money (Commercial) is Bearish while Retail (dumb money) is Bullish -- classic contrarian distribution warning. This directly contradicts the Bullish speculator-side read above -- weigh it before treating that as a clean signal.

Smart Money Score: Score -33, prior week -24 -- stable.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 28). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

US30	Commercial: Bearish IDX 38	Asset Manager: Bullish IDX 72	Leveraged Funds: Bullish IDX 93	Retail: Bullish IDX 68
	Alignment: DIVERGE		Score: -9 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: +0	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds flipped from net short 5,386 (4 wks ago) to net long 2,124 now. COT Index 93 (Bullish). Leveraged Funds delta turned positive (short-covering or new longs). Asset Manager net +14,911 -> +12,209 (-2,702 over 4 wks). COT Index 72 (Bullish). Asset Manager delta turned negative (new shorts or long liquidation). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +10,026 -> +9,599 (-427). COT Index 55 (Neutral). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 38 (Bearish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 68 (Bullish).

Analysis: Source divergence: CFTC Bullish (IDX 93) vs Tradingster Neutral (IDX 55). Hedge-fund sources disagree -- context only. Leveraged Funds crossed from net short to net long -- significant momentum shift. Smart money (Commercial) is Bearish while Retail (dumb money) is Bullish -- classic contrarian distribution warning. This directly contradicts the Bullish speculator-side read above -- weigh it before treating that as a clean signal.

Smart Money Score: Score -9, prior week +0 -- stable.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 38). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

BTC	Commercial: Bearish IDX 12	Asset Manager: Bearish IDX 11	Leveraged Funds: Bullish IDX 100	Retail: Bearish IDX 19

	Alignment: CONFIRMED		Score: +10 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: +8	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -6,856 -> -3,979 (+2,877 over 4 wks). COT Index 100 (Bullish). Asset Manager net +3,586 -> +2,754 (-832 over 4 wks). COT Index 11 (Bearish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +2,465 -> +2,720 (+255). COT Index 86 (Bullish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 12 (Bearish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 19 (Bearish).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bullish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). CFTC IDX=100 near historical bullish extreme -- crowd fully positioned long; exhaustion or reversal risk elevated.

Smart Money Score: Score +10, prior week +8 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: Crypto Fear & Greed Index: 30/100 (Fear) -- independent retail/market sentiment gauge, not CFTC data.

This week (Oct 30):

Bearish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme short (IDX 12) vs. Hedge funds IDX 100, Non-Commercial IDX 86 at the opposite extreme (long). Lean Bearish with Commercials. Favor short v7 signals; no COT support for longs.

Next week (Nov 3):

Bearish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX <= 20 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

-- COMMODITIES --

GOLD	Commercial: Neutral IDX 41	Asset Manager: N/A	Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 20	Retail: Neutral IDX 54
	Alignment: DIVERGE		Score: -19 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: -38	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net +124,418 -> +107,404 (-17,014 over 4 wks). COT Index 20 (Bearish). Leveraged Funds covering above-average pace. Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +218,632 -> +186,451 (-32,181). COT Index 57 (Neutral). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 41 (Neutral), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 54 (Neutral).

Analysis: Source divergence: CFTC Bearish (IDX 20) vs Tradingster Neutral (IDX 57). Hedge-fund sources disagree -- context only.

Smart Money Score: Score -19, prior week -38 -- edge collapsed to neutral from a real reading last week.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 41). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

SILVER	Commercial: Bullish IDX 62	Asset Manager: N/A	Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 0	Retail: Neutral IDX 48
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		Score: -4 (Neutral / No Edge) | Prior Wk: -11	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net +7,738 -> +2,902 (-4,836 over 4 wks). COT Index 0 (Bearish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +22,083 -> +19,703 (-2,380). COT Index 36 (Bearish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 62 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 48 (Neutral).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bearish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). CFTC IDX=0 near historical bearish extreme -- crowd very one-sided short; contrarian squeeze risk is elevated. Commercials (Bullish) and Retail (Neutral) disagree, though not both at a clean bullish/bearish extreme -- worth noting who's on which side of this move.

Smart Money Score: Score -4, prior week -11 -- stable.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 62). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

CRUDE	Commercial: Bullish IDX 93	Asset Manager: N/A	Leveraged Funds: Bullish IDX 73	Retail: Neutral IDX 55
	Alignment: DIVERGE		Score: +32 (Bullish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: +33	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net +122,916 -> +99,771 (-23,145 over 4 wks). COT Index 73 (Bullish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net +109,463 -> +74,343 (-35,120). COT Index 5 (Bearish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 93 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 55 (Neutral).

Analysis: Source divergence: CFTC Bullish (IDX 73) vs Tradingster Bearish (IDX 5). Hedge-fund sources disagree -- context only. Non-Commercial IDX=5 also at bearish extreme -- broad spec group maximally short. Commercials (Bullish) and Retail (Neutral) disagree, though not both at a clean bullish/bearish extreme -- worth noting who's on which side of this move.

Smart Money Score: Score +32, prior week +33 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: EIA weekly crude stocks: -1,892 thousand barrels (Neutral) -- real supply/demand fundamentals, not positioning data.

This week (Oct 30):

Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 93) vs. Non-Commercial IDX 5 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.

Next week (Nov 3):

Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

NATGAS	Commercial: Bullish IDX 100	Asset Manager: N/A	Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 0	Retail: Bearish IDX 38
	Alignment: CONFIRMED		Score: +33 (Bullish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: +37	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -132,849 -> -205,464 (-72,615 over 4 wks). COT Index 0 (Bearish). Leveraged Funds pressing at above-average pace. Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net -231,020 -> -255,164 (-24,144). COT Index 2 (Bearish). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 100 (Bullish), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 38 (Bearish).

Analysis: Both hedge-fund sources (CFTC and Tradingster) are bearish -- this is crowd positioning, context only; the lean comes from Commercials (see This week). CFTC IDX=0 near historical bearish extreme -- crowd very one-sided short; contrarian squeeze risk is elevated. Non-Commercial IDX=2 also at bearish extreme -- broad spec group maximally short. Smart money (Commercial) is Bullish while Retail (dumb money) is Bearish -- classic contrarian accumulation signal. This directly contradicts the Bearish speculator-side read above -- weigh it before treating that as a clean signal.

Smart Money Score: Score +33, prior week +37 -- stable.

Third-Source Check: EIA natural gas storage (week of 2026-10-23): +80 Bcf vs. 5-yr average +80 Bcf for the same week (Neutral), storage +0.0% vs. 5-yr average -- real supply/demand fundamentals, not positioning data.

This week (Oct 30):

Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 100) vs. Hedge funds IDX 0, Non-Commercial IDX 2 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.

Next week (Nov 3):

Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

-- VOLATILITY (VIX) --

VIX	Commercial: Neutral IDX 47	Asset Manager: Bullish IDX 69	Leveraged Funds: Bearish IDX 31	Retail: Bearish IDX 28
	Alignment: DIVERGE		Score: +22 (Bullish (Fade Retail)) | Prior Wk: +20	

4-Week Trend: Leveraged Funds net -7,467 -> -26,334 (-18,867 over 4 wks). COT Index 31 (Bearish). Asset Manager net -66,500 -> -44,424 (+22,076 over 4 wks). COT Index 69 (Bullish). Non-Commercial (Tradingster, Leveraged Funds + Asset Manager combined) net -79,610 -> -77,466 (+2,144). COT Index 55 (Neutral). Commercial (hedgers) IDX 47 (Neutral), Retail (non-reportable) IDX 28 (Bearish).

Analysis: Source divergence: CFTC Bearish (IDX 31) vs Tradingster Neutral (IDX 55). Hedge-fund sources disagree -- context only. Commercials (Neutral) and Retail (Bearish) disagree, though not both at a clean bullish/bearish extreme -- worth noting who's on which side of this move.

Smart Money Score: Score +22, prior week +20 -- stable.

This week (Oct 30):

No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 47). Trade v7 signals on their own.

Next week (Nov 3):

No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

Bias Summary -- Oct 30 -> Nov 3

SYM	LEVERAGED FUNDS INDEX	NON-COMMERCIAL INDEX	ALIGNMENT	THIS WEEK (Oct 30)	NEXT WEEK (Nov 3)
EUR	0	0	CONFIRMED	Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 90) vs. Hedge funds IDX 0, Non-Commercial IDX 0 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.	Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.
GBP	35	11	CONFIRMED	Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 88) vs. Non-Commercial IDX 11 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.	Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.
JPY	73	79	CONFIRMED	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 24). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
NZD	27	7	CONFIRMED	Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 91) vs. Non-Commercial IDX 7 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.	Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.
USD	82	42	DIVERGE	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 60). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
ES	42	53	NEUTRAL	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 37). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
NQ	86	69	CONFIRMED	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 28). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
US30	93	55	DIVERGE	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 38). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
BTC	100	86	CONFIRMED	Bearish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme short (IDX 12) vs. Hedge funds IDX 100, Non-Commercial IDX 86 at the opposite extreme (long). Lean Bearish with Commercials. Favor short v7 signals; no COT support for longs.	Bearish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX <= 20 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.
GOLD	20	57	DIVERGE	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 41). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
SILVER	0	36	CONFIRMED	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 62). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.
CRUDE	73	5	DIVERGE	Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 93) vs. Non-Commercial IDX 5 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.	Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.

SYM	LEVERAGED FUNDS INDEX	NON-COMMERCIAL INDEX	ALIGNMENT	THIS WEEK (Oct 30)	NEXT WEEK (Nov 3)
NATGAS	0	2	CONFIRMED	Bullish COT setup. Commercials at an extreme long (IDX 100) vs. Hedge funds IDX 0, Non-Commercial IDX 2 at the opposite extreme (short). Lean Bullish with Commercials. Favor long v7 signals; no COT support for shorts.	Bullish lean with Commercials holds through Nov 3 while Commercials stay at IDX >= 80 and the other side stays at the opposite extreme.
VIX	31	55	DIVERGE	No COT edge. Commercials are not at an extreme (IDX 47). Trade v7 signals on their own.	No COT edge through Nov 3 unless Commercials reach an extreme against hedge funds or retail.

Key themes this week: Extreme bearish positioning (IDX <=5): EUR, SILVER, NATGAS -- crowd very one-sided; contrarian squeeze risk elevated. **Extreme bullish positioning (IDX >=95):** BTC -- crowd fully long; exhaustion risk elevated. **COT setups (lean with Commercials):** EUR (Bullish), GBP (Bullish), NZD (Bullish), BTC (Bearish), CRUDE (Bullish), NATGAS (Bullish) -- Commercials at an extreme (IDX >= 80 or <= 20) with hedge funds and/or retail at the opposite extreme. **Diverging sources (watch closely):** USD, US30, GOLD, CRUDE, VIX. **Institutional vs. independent third-source divergence:** EUR, JPY, USD, CRUDE -- COT positioning disagrees with the non-CFTC check.

Report generated: October 30, 2026 | CFTC data: positions as of October 27, 2026 | Next CFTC release: Friday after Nov 3 (positions as of Tue Nov 3)